

Shortcomings of Marxist Method.

Functionalist



look for consensus,
equilibrium,
things working together
peacefully.

Marxist



looking for conflict,
in equitable distribution
of power.

- All people looking for conflict are NOT Marxists but All marxists are looking for conflict.

"Those who have more relation to production facilities have more power" - this is materialist perspective of power.

For Marx, material was the base of power

Why was Marxism unsuccessful in India?

Unlike other agrarian society, India's social hierarchy is deeply shaped by caste rather than just class. Marxism's class-based analysis failed to address caste oppression which remained a dominant force.

What about those who don't own property in the Marxist sense but are still powerful?

Ex- Teacher, shopkeeper, artisans.....

→ Intellectual capital is being sold/used in these cases; no need for physical power always.

Marx said eventually society can be arranged in dichotomous (2-class) system.

But this was not the case with India due to intellectual and symbolic capital.

- Caste and class may not map onto each other.
- A person's position in caste hierarchy need not be the similar in class hierarchy.

Class → economic power

Caste → social power

- Class is dynamic & strategic as people can improve skills and earn more economic wealth.
- Caste is also a little bit dynamic, but it is very slow over generations, and is for a whole group.
Ex — gonds tribe over long time laid claim over Kshatriyas.

Srinivas — "Even a poor brahmin will have superiority over a rich dalit."

Marx was talking more about economic power.

→ Social capital is also an important form of capital, not only economic capital.

Max Weber — divided power in 3 major parts.

Class	status	party
↓	↓	↓
economic	difficult to define	Political

Status is not always economic but it can contribute.

Ex — After Independence, royal families may not have had political power but still they had high status.

Ralph Dahrendorf (conflict theorist)

He said power is constantly circulating through Society.

- When we compare power, we generally mix different contexts like political, educational, etc. which makes it difficult to compare different individuals.

- Some +ve context of power trumps any other -ve one.

Ex — DM madam in panchayat could have been from a lower caste, but still be powerful.

→ There may be practises which are illegal, but are culturally sanctioned.

Ex — bribe and get goons for power, dalits not allowed to drink from common wells.

- power circulates
- have / have nots is not clearly demarcated.
- not a zero sum game.

Ex — Damaad ji may not always, everywhere be in same status as shown.